

STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE (SOP)

Weekly UK Banks Adverse News Intelligence & Screening Workflow

1. PURPOSE

This Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) defines the standardized end-to-end process for executing a weekly Adverse News Screening across all regulated UK financial institutions. It establishes criteria for filtering out neutral and positive media coverage, identifying material risk indicators, verifying primary regulatory sources, attaching direct source URLs, and generating executive-ready intelligence briefings.

2. SCREENING SCOPE & INSTITUTION LIST

- **Entities Screened:** All regulated UK financial institutions present in the master monitoring repository (including Tier-1 clearing banks, challenger banks, international subsidiaries, and building societies).
- **Time Horizon:** Rolling 7-Day Window (e.g., T-7 to T-0).
- **Excluded Content:** Routine earnings announcements, product launches, positive ESG metrics, neutral market commentaries, executive promotions, and standard commercial marketing.

3. THE 5-PILLAR ADVERSE NEWS FRAMEWORK

All findings must be classified into one or more of the following five core risk categories:

Pillar	Risk Category	Specific Material Triggers	Verification & Source Linking Standard
1	Regulatory & Legal Enforcement	Enforcement actions, fines, settlements, license revocations, class actions, litigation.	Link to <i>FCA</i> , <i>NYDFS</i> , <i>SEC</i> , <i>PRA</i> , or High Court legal filings.
2	Financial Crime & Integrity	AML/KYC breaches, sanctions violations (OFAC/OFSI), fraud, market manipulation.	Link to regulatory notices, <i>NCA</i> , or investigative financial media.
3	Executive & Key Person Risk	Governance disputes, misconduct, regulatory disqualifications, conflicts of interest.	Link to corporate statements or mainstream press investigations.
4	Operational & Security Risks	Core outages, cyber attacks, ransomware,	Link to status pages, <i>Pay.UK</i> , <i>BoE</i> , or

Pillar	Risk Category	Specific Material Triggers	Verification & Source Linking Standard
		data leaks, reserve/backing doubts.	security advisories.
5	Financial Health & Stability	Credit downgrades, liquidity crunches, emergency capital, mass lay-offs (>15%).	Link to credit rating agencies (<i>Moody's/S&P</i>), <i>LSE</i> filings, or financial press.

4. OPERATIONAL WORKFLOW & EXECUTION

Step 1: Raw Data Retrieval & HTML Ingestion

1. Extract weekly news dump (HTML or unstructured text file) from the monitoring platform (e.g., Silobreaker / Meltwater).
2. Save file using standardized naming format: UK_Banks_YYYY-MM-DD.html.

Step 2: Deep Research Execution via Gemini

1. Open Gemini interface.
2. Upload the HTML/text file containing the 7-day monitoring harvest.
3. Input the **Master Screening Prompt** (see Section 5 below).
4. Execute deep research mode to cross-reference raw items against primary regulatory databases (*FCA, Bank of England, PRA, HM Treasury*).

Step 3: Source Linking & Verification

1. Ensure every adverse incident includes a direct Markdown hyperlinked source (e.g., [FCA Statement](https://www.fca.org.uk)).
2. Verify that source links point to reputable regulatory portals, court registers, or primary financial press (*Reuters, Financial Times, Bloomberg, Investment Week, Morningstar*).

Step 4: Quality Control & Formatting

1. Confirm zero inclusion of neutral or positive news.
2. Ensure formatting uses **bolding** for monetary values, regulatory bodies, and entity names, and *italics* for legal frameworks/consultations.
3. Verify that institutional grouping clearly distinguishes between **Systemic Operational Outages** and **Entity-Specific Misconduct**.

Step 5: Executive Delivery

1. Copy updated plain-text output with inline hyperlinked source URLs into the email client body.
2. Dispatch to target recipients with the standardized subject header: UK Banks Weekly Adverse News Briefing (DD-DD Month YYYY).

5. MASTER GEMINI PROMPT TEMPLATES

Template A: Deep Research & Source-Linked Screening Prompt

Role: Expert Risk Intelligence Specialist executing an Adverse News Screening for UK Financial Institutions.

Input File: UK_Banks_YYYY-MM-DD.html

Task Instructions:

1. Conduct a rigorous screening of all UK banks in the attached list over the last 7 days.
2. STRICT FILTERING: Exclude ALL neutral and positive news. Only extract material ADVERSE news.
3. Map every identified adverse event against these 5 Pillars:
 - Pillar 1: Regulatory & Legal Enforcement (fines, lawsuits, license suspensions)
 - Pillar 2: Financial Crime & Integrity (AML/KYC failures, sanctions, fraud)
 - Pillar 3: Executive & Key Person Risk (misconduct, forced exits, governance disputes)
 - Pillar 4: Operational & Security Risks (outages, cyber attacks, core infrastructure downtime)
 - Pillar 5: Financial Health & Stability (credit downgrades, liquidity issues, severe lay-offs)
4. MANDATORY SOURCE LINKING: For every incident identified, find and attach the explicit primary source URL or reputable financial press hyperlink in Markdown format (e.g., [FCA Enforcement] (<https://www.fca.org.uk>)).
5. FORMATTING: Direct, impersonal, concise bullet points. Use ****bold**** for key entities, fines, and data points; use **italics** for regulatory frameworks and court titles.